CITY OF READING, OHIO
COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES – LEGISLATIVE SESSION
JULY 21, 2026 – 7:30 PM

For the full detail of this evening's Council Meeting, please visit www.watchreadingohio.com.

CALL TO ORDER
President of Council, Mr. Mattscheck called the meeting to order at 7:30 PM.

INVOCATION AND PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE
President of Council, Mr. Mattscheck led those in attendance in a prayer and then the Pledge of Allegiance.

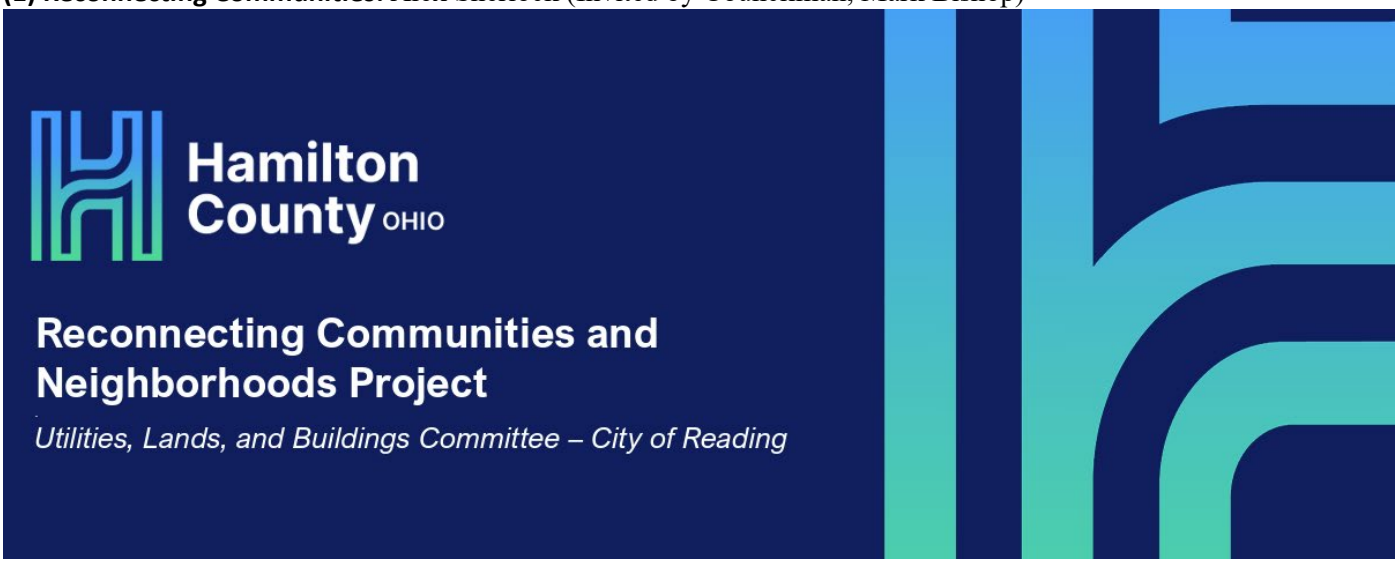
ROLL CALL
Council Members Present: Mr. Powell, Mr. Bronner, Mr. Bishop, Mr. Boehner, Mr. Thamann, Mrs. Kroeger, & Mrs. Eadicicco.

OTHER CITY OFFICIALS PRESENT:
Mayor Bo Bemmes & Clerk of Council Carla Bronner

AMENDMENTS TO THE AGENDA
Motion made by Mrs. Eadicicco, seconded by Mrs. Kroeger, to add Kelly Scocco (Director of the City of Columbus Department of Public Service) to the agenda as a Guest Speaker, after the scheduled Guest Speaker, Reconnecting Communities. Motion carried by voice vote.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Motion to approve the July 7, 2026, Council Meeting Minutes made by Mrs. Eadicicco, seconded by Mr. Bishop. Motion carried by voice vote.

GUEST SPEAKERS:
(1) Reconnecting Communities: Alex Sherlock (Invited by Councilman, Mark Bishop)



RCN Context

The Reconnecting Communities and Neighborhoods (RCN) Grant Program is a federal grant overseen by the U.S. Department of Transportation that aims to mitigate modern inequities that have resulted from the presence of transportation facilities such as railways and interstate highways.

- *Over $1.7 billion in funds were made available for planning, capital construction, and Regional Partnership Challenge applications.*
- *The First Suburbs Consortium of Southwest Ohio (FSC-SWO) and the Hamilton County Transportation Improvement District (TID) applied as a Regional Partnership Challenge.*

Historic challenges related to the railways have been reflected in recent incidents in the Mill Creek Valley.

A recent train derailment in Wyoming, Ohio represents the potential for a disastrous incident to impact Hamilton County communities near private railways.





Study Area

Village of Arlington Heights
Village of Evendale
Village of Lincoln Heights
Village of Lockland
City of Reading
City of Sharonville

Kemper Road
Sharon Road
Glendale Milford Road
Shepherd Avenue / Smalley Road / Columbia Rd.
Wyoming Avenue / Benson Street
Clark Street / Mill Street
Davis Street
Galbraith Road

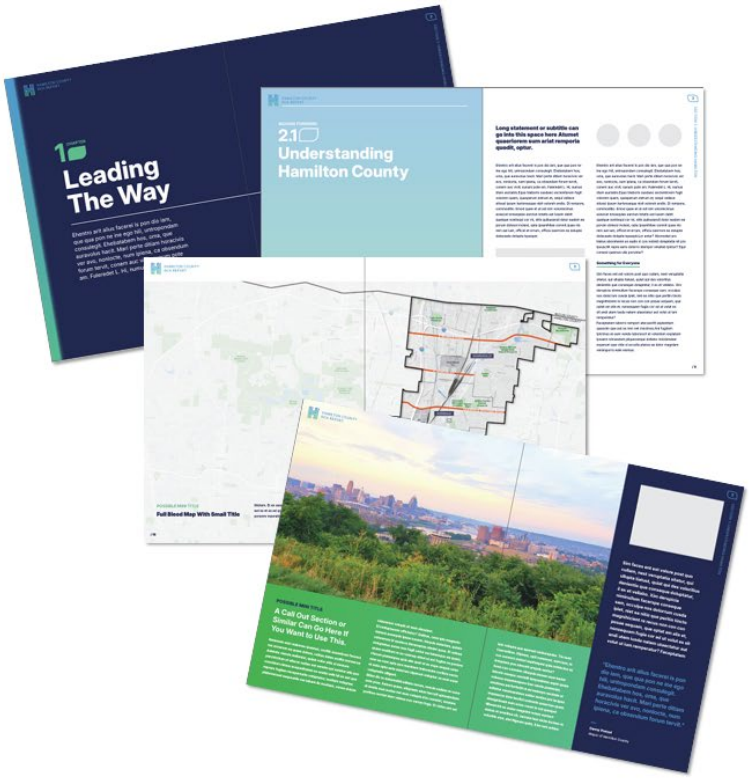


Deliverables

State of the Study Area (Existing Conditions Report)

Conceptual Designs for Larger, Transformative Projects

Planning Study Document to be Adopted by Local Municipalities



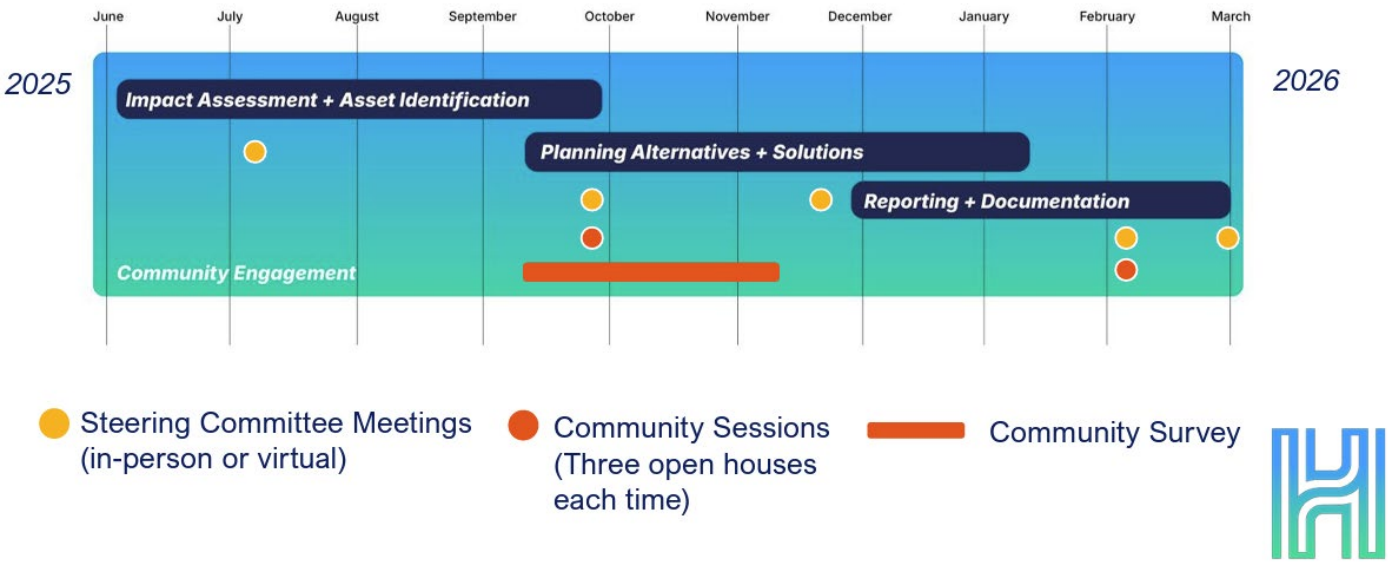
Steering Committee Members

Jen Bruner – *Village of Arlington Heights*
James Jeffers – *Village of Evendale*
Tonya Key – *Village of Lincoln Heights*
Doug Wehmeyer – *Village of Lockland*
Patrick Ross – *City of Reading*
John Creech – *City of Sharonville*
Ruby Kinsey-Mumphrey – *FSC-SW Ohio*
Robyn Bancroft – *OKI*
Dan Ferguson – *Alloy Development Co.*
Brad Bowers – *Tri-State Trails*
Michele Gottschlich – *Mill Creek Collaborative*
Bob Ashbrock – *Mill Creek Collaborative*

Consultant Team

Sarah McColley – *Project Manager; Perkins&Will*
Andrew Broderick – *Planning Principal; Perkins&Will*
Cassandra Rice – *Lead Urban Planner; Perkins&Will*
Todd Snapp – *Design Advisor; Perkins&Will*
Dave Wormald – *Transportation Planner; AECOM*
Chris Brewer – *Economic Development Planner; AECOM*
Joe Ivanyo – *Rail Group Director; AECOM*
Gabi Brazzil – *Equity Transportation Planner; Nelson/Nygaard*
Crystal Kendrick – *Communications; Voice of Your Customer*
Nichole Lashley – *Environmental Engineer; ASC Group*

Project Timeline



Priority Projects

PS-1 - Explore the re-use of the I-75 vacated property

NS-1 - Improve rail operations to enhance mobility

NS-3 - Improve east-west connections in Lockland, Reading, and Lincoln Heights



PS-1 Re-use the ODOT right-of-way under northbound I-75 viaduct following the removal for a linear park and recreation space

Cost Level: $$$

Short-term (3-5 years) for viaduct removal to Long-term (8+ years)

Description

- Regrade the land underneath the northbound I-75 viaduct once removed (in 2030) to accommodate a trail corridor that uses Mill Creek as an amenity
- Place trailheads at key street intersections
- Build spur trails to connect communities to the east and west of the trail corridor
- Use stormwater management and streambank remediation best practices, which should be coordinated with the Metropolitan Sewer District's (MSD) upcoming projects
- Consider how this project could improve the redevelopment potential of adjacent properties

Constraints

- Truck traffic on surrounding streets
- Timeline of the ODOT project
- ODOT's plans for the embankments south of Davis Street and the potential to retain land ownership



Figure 3.2.7 Future Trailhead along Mill Creek and Wyoming Avenue / Benson Street

Municipalities Project Is In

- Arlington Heights
- Reading
- Lockland

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Great Parks

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Mill Creek Alliance
- Tri-State Trails
- ODOT
- Hamilton County
- Village of Lockland, Village of Arlington Heights, City of Reading

Potential Funding Sources

- Capital budget requests through the State of Ohio
- OKI's STBG and CMAQ programs
- ODOT (as mitigation for removing lane miles and for flood and stormwater management)
- FEMA
- EPA 319
- Federal discretionary grants for capital construction (BUILD, SS4A, ATIIP)
- SORTA's Transit Infrastructure Fund
- ODNR Clean Ohio Trail Fund



NS-1 Provide an east-west, grade-separated connection from Shepherd Avenue to Columbia Avenue (bypass Smalley Road railroad crossing) - Crossing ID 524719X

Cost Level: $$$

Long-term (8+ years)

Description

- Connect the two streets with a new two-lane overpass bridge on new alignment over the Norfolk Southern railroad tracks, Cavett Avenue, and commercial properties
- Include a shared-use path along the road connection from the existing shared-use paths on Aviation Way and at Koenig Park
- View more details on page 142

Constraints

- Feasibility of the crossing
- Railroad coordination
- Aerial utilities
- Local access management
- Land acquisition and affected property owners

Municipalities Project Is In

- Lockland
- Reading



Figure 3.2.12 Tri-State Trails - Mill Creek Triangle Trail Plan

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- REDI Cincinnati
- Hamilton County Economic Development
- Hamilton County TID
- Village of Lockland and City of Reading

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Norfolk Southern
- Village of Lockland and / or City of Reading
- Hamilton County TID
- Hamilton County Engineer's Office

Potential Funding Sources

- State of Ohio 629 funds
- OKI MTP
- Norfolk Southern may fund if crossings are eliminated
- Private entities (GE, Givaudan)
- SORTA Transit Infrastructure Fund
- Hamilton County Engineer's Office
- Ohio Public Works Commission (OPWC)
- ODOT Municipal Bridge Program
- FRA / ORDC Grade Crossing Elimination Program
- ORDC Cincinnati Railroad Congestion Mitigation Plan



NS-3 Connect Shepherd Lane to Glendale Milford Road and connect Mangham Drive south into Lockland with a connection to Forrer Street south of Shepherd Lane

Cost Level: $$

Mid-term (6-8 years)

Description

- Connect Magnolia Drive along I-75 north from Mangham Drive to Glendale Milford Road via AeroHub Boulevard
- Create a "T" intersection at Mangham Drive and Magnolia Drive by the Marianna Terrace apartments owned by the Cincinnati Metropolitan Housing Authority (CMHA)
- Connect Mangham Drive across Shepherd Lane to Forrer Street in Lockland.
- Advance ODOT's property connections with Forrer Street and Catherine Avenue
- View more details on page 144

Constraints

- Land ownership and the number of municipalities involved
- Neighborhood residents' opinions of the connections
- Current AeroHub plans do not show the connection

Municipalities Project Is In

- Evendale
- Lincoln Heights
- Lockland

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- REDI Cincinnati
- Hamilton County Economic Development
- Hamilton County TID
- ODOT
- Villages of Evendale, Lincoln Heights, and Lockland

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Villages of Evendale, Lincoln Heights, and Lockland
- City of Cincinnati (for connection to former CPD firing range property)
- CMHA
- ODOT
- AeroHub Innovation District

Potential Funding Sources

- Safe Routes to School (ODOT)
- Hamilton County Public Health
- OKI's STBG program
- ODOT
- Northern extents could be funded with State's 629 funds
- SORTA Transit Infrastructure Fund
- CDBG for sidewalks (LMI requirement)



Figure 3.2.15 Potential Magnolia Drive to Glendale Milford Road connection



Figure 3.2.16 Potential Forrer Street to Shepherd Lane connection



Other Projects

NS-#

Project Type — Project Number

S-#	Streetscapes and Rail Crossing Improvements
PS-#	Public Space
TR-# , TD-#	Trail Routes and Trail Design
NS-#	New Streets & Intersections
R-#	Rail Improvements
T-#	Transit Improvements
PR-#	Program Improvements
P-#	Policy Improvements



S-# Streetscapes and Rail Crossing Improvements

Enhancing streets and rail crossings to create safer, more comfortable connections for pedestrians, cyclists, and drivers while improving the overall character of the study area.



S-1 Improve the Clark Mill Road Streetscape

Cost Level: $$ Mid-term (6-8 years)

Description

- Make intersection and crosswalk safety improvements
- Implement stormwater management
- Build better and wider sidewalks where feasible
- Add wayfinding signage
- Add a trailhead with crossing at Mill Creek (for the future trail noted in the Tri-State Trails Plan and in project PS-1)

Constraints

- Ownership of the land along Mill Creek
- Right-of-way (ROW) acquisition along the street
- Norfolk Southern at-grade crossing

Municipalities Project Is In

- Arlington Heights
- Lockland
- Reading



Figure 3.2.5 Facing North at Railroad Tracks (behind view) on Clark Mill Road

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Village of Arlington Heights, Village of Lockland, and / or City of Reading
- Hamilton County Transportation Improvement District (TID)

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Mill Creek Alliance / Tri-State Trails
- ODOT
- Hamilton County
- Village of Arlington Heights, Village of Lockland, and / or City of Reading
- 1001 Colors
- Black Arts Speaks
- Norfolk Southern
- Ohio Rail Development Corporation (ORDC)

Potential Funding Sources

- State of Ohio 629 funds
- SORTATransit Infrastructure Fund
- General Funds from municipalities
- Community Development Block Grants (CDBG) *[there are low to moderate income (LMI) requirements]*

S-2 Make pedestrian connectivity improvements on Columbia Avenue

Cost Level: $$ Short-term (3-5 years)

Description

- Restripe the lanes
- Add bump-outs to reduce crossing distance
- Improve ADA features at intersections
- Add better signage for drivers
- Focus on the area around Koenig Park

Constraints

- Land acquisition if the ROW needs to be widened

Municipalities Project Is In

- Lockland
- Reading



Figure 3.2.6 Facing Southeast at East Street

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Village of Lockland and / or City of Reading
- Hamilton County TID

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Village of Lockland and / or City of Reading
- 1001 Colors
- Black Arts Speaks

Potential Funding Sources

- Metropolitan Transportation Plan (MTP) / Transportation Improvement Program (TIP)
- Safe Routes to School (ODOT)
- Hamilton County Public Health
- OKI Transportation Alternatives (TA) program
- SORTA Transit Infrastructure Fund
- CDBG (for sidewalks; LMI requirement)

S-5 Improve at-grade railroad crossings with reported blocked crossings for pedestrians and cyclists

Cost Level: $ Mid-term (6-8 years)

Description

- Focus on the crossings with reported blocked crossings and delays
- Make sure at-grade crossings are in compliance with MUTCD
- Provide safe spaces to wait and add benches, trees, lighting, stop bars for cars, signage
- Provide wider and better sidewalks on the streets that cross the railroad tracks

Constraints

- Land acquisition if the ROW needs to be widened

Municipalities Project Is In

- Arlington Heights
- Lincoln Heights
- Lockland
- Reading
- Sharonville

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

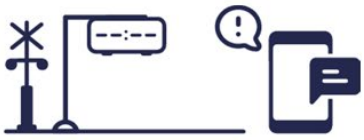
- OKI
- Hamilton County TID

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Hamilton County
- All municipalities where crossings exist
- 1001 Colors
- Black Arts Speaks

Potential Funding Sources

- ORDC
- FRA
- Norfolk Southern
- Public Utilities Commission of Ohio
- ODOT
- OKI
- SORTA Transit Infrastructure Fund



PR-# Program Improvements

Implementing programs and initiatives that activate spaces, support community use, and enhance the long-term success of physical improvements.

PR-1 Add digital signage that provides advanced messaging / notice for blocked railroad crossings

Cost Level: $ Immediate-term (0-2 years)

Description

- Provide this signage at multiple intersections and / or use 311 text messaging.
- Use traffic patterns to help provide advance notice along east-west corridors subject to frequent blocked crossings
- Use wireless connectivity to advanced dynamic warning signs east and west of grade crossings

Constraints

- Will require interface with Norfolk Southern and CSX train detection and crossing warning systems
- Ongoing potential Union Pacific acquisition of Norfolk Southern

Municipalities Project Is In

- All

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- OKI
- Hamilton County TID
- Norfolk Southern
- ODOT

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- All municipalities
- ODOT
- Norfolk Southern and CSX
- OKI

Potential Funding Sources

- ORDC
- FRA
- Norfolk Southern and CSX
- Public Utilities Commission of Ohio
- ODOT

TR-# TD-#: Trail Routes and Trail Design

Expanding and improving trail connections to create a continuous, safe, and accessible network for walking and biking throughout the six municipalities.

TR-1: Add trail segments to complete the loop around GE Aerospace in Evendale and connect into Lincoln Heights

Cost Level: $$ — Short-term (3-5 years)

Description

- Connect the existing trail on Glendale-Milford Road to the existing trail along the western edge of GE Aerospace
- Connect the GE Aerospace trail to the trail at Koenig Park on the southern end in Reading, which connects to the proposed trail along Mill Creek
- Go over the interstate on Aviation Way to connect this loop into Lincoln Heights where the proposed trail ends at Leggett by Wyoming Park
- Enhance appeal of existing trail with tree planting

Constraints

- Need approval from GE Aerospace

Municipalities Project Is In

- Evendale
- Lincoln Heights
- Reading

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Great Parks
- Village of Lincoln Heights and / or Village of Evendale
- Tri-State Trails

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Hamilton County
- Mill Creek Alliance
- GE Aerospace
- Village of Lincoln Heights and / or Village of Evendale

Potential Funding Sources

- Capital budget requests through the State
- OKI's TA program
- SORTA Transit Infrastructure Fund
- ODNR Clean Ohio Trail Fund
- Private funding

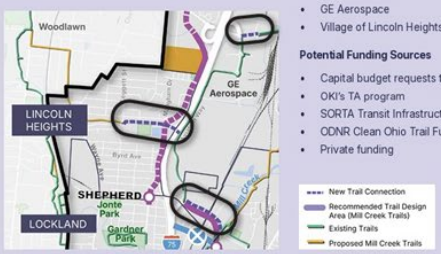


Figure 3.2.8 Future Trailhead along Mill Creek and Wyoming Ave

NS-#: New Streets and Intersections

Introducing strategic street and intersection improvements to improve connectivity, reduce travel barriers, and support safer multimodal movement.

NS-2: Improve access to the Port Authority's development site (Forge) west of Reading Road and Cooper Avenue

Cost Level: $$ — Short-term (3-5 years)

Description

- Connect Cooper Road over Mill Creek and potentially the railroad tracks to Shepherd Avenue
- Coordinate with the Port Authority and the municipalities affected

Constraints

- Could add another railroad crossing
- Crossing Mill Creek
- Cost
- Industrial development
- Environmental mitigation

Municipalities Project Is In

- Evendale
- Reading

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Port Authority
- Hamilton County Economic Development
- REDI Cincinnati
- Village of Evendale and / or City of Reading

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- The Port
- General Electric
- Hamilton County
- Village of Evendale and / or City of Reading
- SORTA
- Indiana and Ohio Railway

Potential Funding Sources

- Federal discretionary grants for capital construction (BUILD). The Port applied for a BUILD grant in 2026.
- SORTA Transit Infrastructure Fund
- JobsOhio



Figure 3.2.13 Proposed Access Drive from Cooper Road



Figure 3.2.14 Proposed Access Drive Facing West on Cooper Road

P-#: Policy Improvements

Advancing policies and regulatory strategies that support implementation, guide development, and reinforce the long-term vision of the study area.

P-1: Make comprehensive plan updates for all municipalities as needed

Cost Level: $ — Immediate-term (0-2 years)

Description

- Re-evaluate desired land uses and focus areas for economic development districts

Municipalities Project Is In

- All

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Hamilton County Planning and Development

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- All municipalities

Potential Funding Sources

- Hamilton County

P-2: Review industrial zoning districts for updates to modern construction and operations

Cost Level: $ — Immediate-term (0-2 years)

Description

- Review industrial zoning requirements and determine if they meet modern-day standards for operations because some zoning codes have not been recently updated.

Municipalities Project Is In

- All

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Hamilton County Planning & Development

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- All municipalities

Potential Funding Sources

- Hamilton County

P-5: Align projects with other initiatives and projects underway

Cost Level: $ — Ongoing

Description

- Align all future projects with other initiatives and projects underway

Municipalities Project Is In

- All

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

- Hamilton County Planning & Development

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- All municipalities
- Hamilton County

Potential Funding Sources

- N/A

P-6: Consider Quiet Zone Designations through these communities

Cost Level: $$ — Mid-term (6-8 years)

Description

- Review the Village of Glendale no-noise ordinance

Constraints

- This will require upgrades to existing crossings to provide full protection and cooperation from affected railroads. People may be less concerned about noise than they are about physical disconnection.

Municipalities Project Is In

- Evendale
- Sharonville
- Reading
- Lincoln Heights
- Arlington Heights

Champion / Potential Grant Applicant

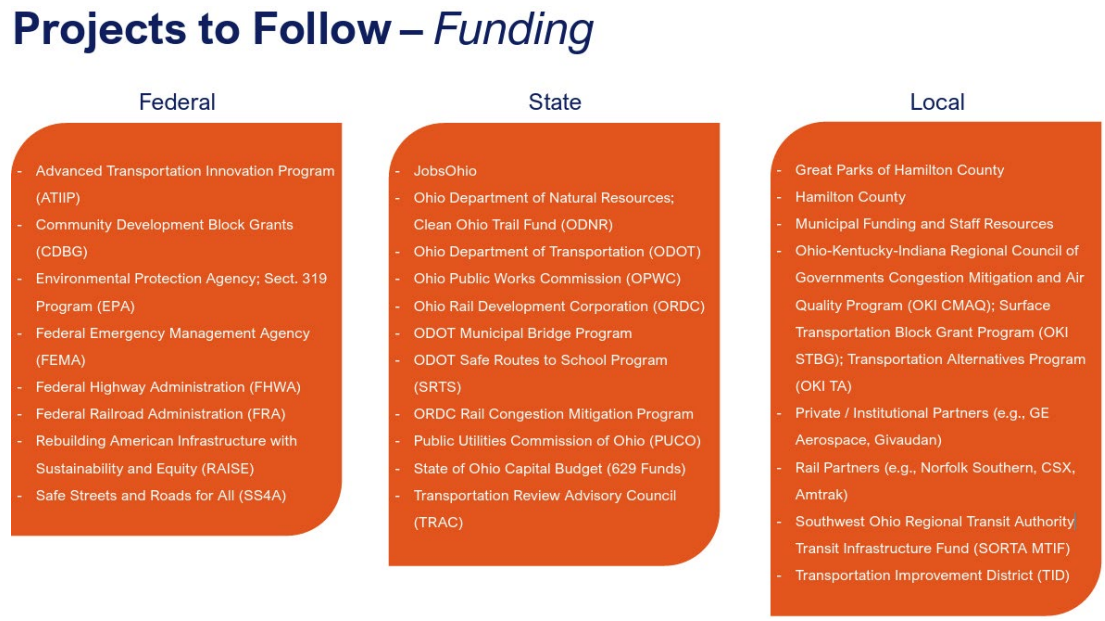
- Hamilton County TID
- All municipalities, except Lockland

Implementation Partners / Stakeholders

- Hamilton County
- Norfolk Southern
- CSX
- Indiana and Ohio Railway
- OKI
- All municipalities, except Lockland

Potential Funding Sources

- Staff time
- OKI
- All municipalities, except Lockland
- Norfolk Southern, CSX, Indiana and Ohio Railway





(2) Scott Knable (Department of Transportation) & Kelly Scocco (Public Service Director of the City of Columbus)
Scott Knable of the Ohio Department of Transportation (ODOT) introduced Kelly Scocco from the City of Columbus to share Columbus' experience with roadway safety improvements similar to those being considered for Reading.

Scott explained that after attending a recent presentation by Kelly, he recognized many similarities between the challenges Columbus had faced and those currently before Reading City Council. He invited Kelly to discuss several roadway improvement projects completed in Columbus and to answer questions based on those experiences.

Introduction
Kelly explained that Columbus refers to these projects as **road optimization** rather than "road diets."

The goal of road optimization is to make roadways as safe as possible while ensuring they function effectively for everyone who uses them, including motorists, bicyclists, pedestrians, and public transit.

She noted that although she had never presented to another city council before, she was passionate about roadway safety and welcomed the opportunity to help another community navigate similar decisions.

Indianola Avenue: The First Road Optimization Project
In 2016, shortly after Mayor Andrew Ginther took office, Columbus proposed converting a section of Indianola Avenue from four travel lanes to three while adding bicycle lanes.

The proposal divided the community. Approximately half of the residents opposed the project, while the other half supported it because of concerns about speeding.

When city officials presented the proposal to the mayor, he asked a simple question:

"Will this make the road feel like a neighborhood street rather than a raceway?"

When staff confirmed that it would, the project moved forward.

Although opponents strongly resisted the project during construction, the controversy disappeared once it was completed. Traffic continued to flow smoothly, congestion never materialized, and the roadway simply functioned as intended.

Kelly acknowledged that, at the time, even transportation professionals questioned whether reducing four lanes to three would create congestion. Instead, drivers naturally merged into a single travel lane where appropriate, and traffic continued moving efficiently.

Livingston Avenue: Addressing Dangerous Speeds
During the COVID-19 pandemic, Livingston Avenue experienced extreme speeding, with some vehicles traveling more than 70 miles per hour.

The speeding became so severe that vehicles were crashing into homes. Residents no longer felt safe walking, biking, or even sitting inside their own houses.

After studying the corridor, Columbus quickly converted the roadway from four lanes to three during a resurfacing project.

The results were dramatic:

- Excessive speeding decreased by more than 90%.
- Drivers continued to travel at the posted speed limit.
- Overall crashes were reduced by 50%.

Kelly emphasized that the objective was never to slow normal traffic below the speed limit. Instead, the design prevented excessive speeding while maintaining efficient traffic flow.

Mound Street
Columbus implemented a similar road optimization project on Mound Street near an elementary school where speeding had become a significant concern.

Following the lane reduction:

- Excessive speeding declined.
- Traffic crashes decreased.
- Safety around the school improved.

Broad Street (U.S. Route 40)
Broad Street originally consisted of seven lanes, including three travel lanes in each direction and a center turn lane.

As part of Columbus' Vision Zero initiative, the city removed one travel lane in each direction.

Vision Zero aims to eliminate all traffic fatalities on Columbus roadways by 2035.

Kelly noted that while Columbus still recorded more than 40 roadway fatalities last year, that number had declined significantly from a high of 72 fatalities in 2021.

The Broad Street project produced impressive safety improvements:

- Traffic crashes decreased by 50%.
- Excessive speeding decreased by 91%.

Protected bicycle lanes also encouraged far greater bicycle use. Within the first five months, bicycle traffic increased from virtually none to approximately 12,000 riders.

Most importantly, roadway safety improved for everyone—not just bicyclists, but motorists as well.

Expanding the Success
More recently, Columbus completed the remainder of the Indianola Avenue project through the Clintonville business district.

Instead of bicycle lanes in some areas, on-street parking was added where appropriate.

The neighborhood welcomed the improvements, traffic congestion did not occur, and the roadway continued to operate effectively.

Lessons Learned
Kelly stressed that she was not trying to persuade Council to support or oppose any particular project. Instead, she wanted to share Columbus' experiences and answer questions.

She recalled that residents along Livingston Avenue feared reducing lanes would divert traffic into nearby neighborhoods. In practice, that never happened because drivers could still travel at the posted speed limit, making alternative routes unnecessary.

When evaluating roadway changes, Columbus focuses on several key considerations:

- Total traffic volume.
- Whether the roadway carries fewer than approximately 20,000 vehicles per day, a threshold where four-lane roads can often be reduced to three lanes without creating congestion.
- Proper intersection design, including dedicated turn lanes that allow turning vehicles to clear through traffic and maintain efficient traffic flow.

A Final Reflection
Kelly concluded by sharing a story that had greatly influenced her perspective.

Several years earlier, she attended a conference where former Hoboken, New Jersey Mayor Ravi Bhalla spoke about his city's commitment to traffic safety.

While serving on city council, Bhalla had voted against a major roadway redesign because of significant public opposition.

Not long afterward, a beloved member of the community was struck and killed while walking on that same roadway.

When Bhalla later became mayor, he committed himself to making roadway safety his highest priority, regardless of public criticism. His guiding principle became being **"unapologetic about saving people's lives."**

Kelly said that message deeply resonated with her. She closed by explaining that her reason for speaking before Reading City Council was simple: if she truly believed in being unapologetic about saving lives, she also had a responsibility to share the experiences and lessons that had proven successful in Columbus.

AUDIENCE ASKING PARTICIPATION:

(1) Patrick McCarthy: thanked the City of Columbus representative for her presentation but expressed concerns about comparing Reading to Columbus.

He noted that Reading is a small, landlocked community of approximately 10,400 residents, while Columbus is the state capital with significantly greater financial resources and the ability to continue expanding. Because of these differences, he questioned whether examples from Columbus were applicable to Reading.

Mr. McCarthy also observed that many of the examples presented were based on projects completed 10 to 12 years ago. He recalled that previous discussions with city officials referenced an ODOT traffic count showing approximately 16,000 vehicles per day on Reading Road. Although he acknowledged the traffic study was a few years old, he confirmed with council members that this was the most recent figure reported by ODOT.

Mr. McCarthy questioned the proposed conversion from four travel lanes to two travel lanes with a center turn lane.

He disagreed with the suggestion that motorists could simply use the center turn lane to drive around stopped buses. In his view, the center lane is intended solely for turning movements and cannot legally function as a passing lane. He stated that he did not believe such a practice would be acceptable in Reading.

Mr. McCarthy asked what financial impact the proposal would have on the City of Reading after ODOT's involvement ended. He questioned the ongoing costs associated with: Maintaining pavement markings, traffic signals, utility expenses & general roadway maintenance.

Council members responded that Reading receives reimbursement from the State of Ohio for maintenance on Reading Road, including snow removal, salt, equipment, and employee time associated with maintaining the roadway.

Mr. McCarthy discussed bicycle opportunities within the city, noting that Reading already has parks and other locations suitable for recreational cycling. Speaking as a cyclist himself, he stated that he has no desire to ride on busy city streets. He cited concerns about vehicle traffic, air pollution, and motorists who fail to notice bicyclists. He questioned whether adding bicycle accommodations to Reading Road would truly improve cyclist safety and expressed skepticism about claims regarding reductions in fatalities without seeing supporting data.

Mr. McCarthy voiced significant concern about how the proposed roadway changes could affect local businesses. He questioned whether any study had been completed to evaluate the economic impact of making businesses more difficult to access. Specifically, he expressed concern that motorists would no longer be able to make convenient turns into businesses and might instead have to wait in the center turn lane or continue past their destination before turning around. He suggested these changes could discourage customers from stopping at local businesses, resulting in lost revenue.

Returning to the comparison between Reading and Columbus, Mr. McCarthy emphasized that Reading's size and geography make it fundamentally different from a large metropolitan area. He argued that improving Reading does not necessarily require reducing the number of travel lanes on Reading Road. Mr. McCarthy suggested that safer bicycle facilities should be located in parks or on dedicated trails where riders of all ages can enjoy cycling away from heavy traffic. He stated that encouraging bicycle traffic on a roadway carrying approximately 16,000 vehicles per day does not appear to be an appropriate solution.

Mr. McCarthy concluded by expressing concern that reducing the number of travel lanes would: Increase travel times, create additional vehicle emissions and air pollution, increase opportunities for crashes & negatively affect local businesses by reducing accessibility.

(2) Bob Wimmers: Began by expressing disappointment that the City of Columbus representative had left immediately after her presentation and not allowing an opportunity to ask questions. Mr. Wimmers said he would like additional information regarding the studies behind the proposal. Specifically, he questioned whether research had been conducted to determine:

- How much the proposed roadway changes would slow traffic.
- What traffic volumes are expected in five, ten, or fifteen years.
- Whether long-term traffic projections had been considered before recommending permanent roadway changes.

He emphasized that once the roadway is redesigned, reversing those changes would be difficult or impractical.

Responding to an earlier comment from a council member that the community would not know the outcome until the changes were implemented, Mr. Wimmers acknowledged that point but stressed that the decision would effectively be permanent. Because of that, he encouraged careful consideration before proceeding with any modifications to Reading Road.

Mr. Wimmers also questioned whether the Columbus representative had conducted any study specific to Reading before making her presentation. He asked whether she was familiar with: Reading's business district, the City's unique traffic patterns & Major local corridors such as Columbia Avenue and Benson Street.

(3) Mark Haeufle: Began by observing that, based on his conversations throughout the community, the majority of residents appear to oppose the proposed Reading Road lane reduction. He stated that whether he is at local organizations or businesses—including the VFW, American Legion, Eagles, Foley's, Benson's, The Valley, or Gertz Pony Keg—most people he speaks with are against the proposal. While he acknowledged that some supporters exist, he believes they are in the minority.

Mr. Haeufle explained that, through his work loading trucks, he is familiar with roadway dimensions and agrees that the current nine-foot travel lanes are narrower than ideal. He also acknowledged that Reading Road has legitimate safety concerns. However,

he believes the primary issue is congestion rather than lane width. He cited several factors that regularly interrupt traffic flow, including: Stopped trains, Metro buses loading and unloading passengers & general traffic congestion

According to Mr. Haeufle, business owners have expressed concern that reducing Reading Road to one travel lane in each direction could significantly harm the local economy. He specifically noted that employees and patrons at Gertz Pony Keg have repeatedly told him they believe the proposal would negatively impact the community.

While acknowledging that the proposed changes might reduce crashes on Reading Road, Mr. Haeufle questioned whether they would simply shift traffic onto neighborhood streets. He expressed concern that motorists seeking to avoid congestion would divert through residential areas, potentially: Increasing traffic on neighborhood streets, creating additional safety concerns for residents and children & hindering emergency response by affecting access for police and fire vehicles.

He also questioned whether increased congestion near City Hall and the public safety facilities could make it more difficult for emergency vehicles to leave the station when responding to calls.

(4) Unnamed Council Guest: Asked what plans are in place to address traffic if the proposed Reading Road lane reduction is implemented. The resident explained that traffic on Columbia Avenue already backs up as far as Jefferson Avenue. As congestion increases, many drivers bypass the traffic by cutting through nearby residential side streets.

The speaker noted that residents who live along these streets have already experienced increased traffic volumes, even without the proposed roadway changes. While acknowledging that predictions about future conditions involve some speculation, the resident emphasized that the current traffic diversion onto neighborhood streets is a documented and ongoing issue.

The resident expressed concern about the driving behavior already occurring on Columbia Avenue. According to the speaker, motorists frequently accelerate aggressively between the stop sign and the traffic signal, creating conditions that resemble a drag strip. The resident suggested that police officers could issue numerous speeding citations because of the frequency of these violations. The speaker also reported witnessing drivers crossing into oncoming traffic lanes to pass vehicles that are traveling at the posted speed limit. These unsafe passing maneuvers already occur where Columbia Avenue transitions into two travel lanes.

The resident concluded by asking what specific plans the City has to address additional traffic diversion if the proposed Reading Road lane reduction is approved. The speaker requested information on how officials intend to manage the anticipated increase in vehicles using neighborhood streets, given that this pattern is already occurring under existing traffic conditions.

(5) Carl Beckman: Introduced himself as a motorist rights advocate and explained that although he lives in Pleasant Ridge rather than Reading, he has a strong interest in the community. He stated that he has followed local issues affecting Reading and encouraged City Council to reject the proposed Reading Road lane reduction.

Mr. Beckman explained that Reading Road serves as an important alternate route whenever nearby highways are closed.

He noted that:

- Interstate 75 was closed for a weekend several weeks earlier, resulting in increased traffic on Reading Road.
- When Interstate 71 northbound is closed, he personally uses Reading Road and U.S. Route 42 to travel north to visit a family member in Lebanon, Ohio.
- More recently, State Route 562 (the Norwood Lateral) was closed following a fatal crash, causing traffic to divert onto local roadways such as Reading Road.

He expressed concern that reducing roadway capacity could make it more difficult for Reading Road to accommodate traffic during these unexpected events.

Mr. Beckman stated that some communities have declined to implement road diet proposals. He cited cities in Northern Kentucky, including Florence, as examples and suggested that Reading should recognize that rejecting the proposal remains a reasonable option.

Mr. Beckman discussed a road diet implemented in Pleasant Ridge, where he said residents have experienced rear-end collisions involving impatient drivers. According to his observations, drivers become frustrated when they are unable to pass slower-moving traffic because only one travel lane is available in each direction.

He explained that when driving on four-lane roads, he typically remains in the right lane and allows faster traffic to pass, believing this reduces his risk of being struck from behind.

Mr. Beckman recalled recent flooding in Pleasant Ridge that caused significant traffic congestion along Montgomery Road. He noted that emergency vehicles, including those from the St. Bernard Fire Department responding to incidents in Cincinnati, encountered difficulty navigating through the heavy traffic. He suggested that roadway capacity should remain sufficient to support emergency response during unusual events such as severe weather.

Mr. Beckman revisited concerns he had raised during a previous council meeting in January regarding delivery vehicles stopping in travel lanes. At that time, snow-covered parking lanes limited available stopping space. However, he stated that even during good weather, delivery vehicles continue to stop in the roadway rather than pulling out of traffic. He explained that this often forces motorists to cross the centerline to continue traveling safely.

Mr. Beckman noted that some municipalities have chosen not to adopt Vision Zero policies. He stated that information regarding Vision Zero is publicly available and encouraged Council members to research the topic independently before making a decision.

Mr. Beckman concluded by expressing concern about the impact of speed humps and speed tables on smaller vehicles. He explained that he drives a Ford Escort and believes these traffic-calming devices place additional wear on his vehicle's suspension system. He also expressed his opinion that speed humps and speed tables can slow emergency vehicles responding to calls.

(6) Unnamed Council Guest: Began by questioning earlier comments regarding tractor-trailers turning onto neighborhood streets, noting that such movements should not normally occur. The resident then asked whether a study had been conducted on the number of crashes occurring along Reading Road. Council responded that the crash analysis was performed by the Ohio Department of Transportation (ODOT) as part of its study and that the findings are included in the agency's report.

The speaker stated that the greatest concern is not Reading Road itself, but the residential streets that connect to it. The resident explained that these neighborhood streets are home to families and children who regularly play outside. If traffic is diverted from Reading Road onto these side streets, the speaker believes those neighborhoods could experience significantly higher traffic volumes and increased safety risks.

The resident acknowledged previous comments suggesting that the community would not know the actual effects of the proposal until it is implemented. However, the speaker expressed concern that waiting to see the outcome could have serious consequences if the anticipated traffic diversion results in a tragic incident. The resident emphasized that if increased neighborhood traffic were to contribute to the injury or death of a child, the community could not simply reverse the consequences afterward. The speaker urged Council to reject the proposed Reading Road lane reduction, stating that protecting the safety of children and preserving the character of Reading's residential neighborhoods should remain the highest priority.

(7) Jennifer Dick: Reminded Council that she had submitted an email during the previous meeting regarding excessive speeding on Harvest Avenue. She noted that she had already shared her views on the proposed Reading Road lane reduction and instead wanted to focus on the continuing safety concerns in her neighborhood. She thanked Mr. Thamann for responding to her concerns and for visiting the area to discuss the issue.

Since that discussion, several additional incidents have occurred. An Amazon delivery truck struck and damaged a neighbor's fence, and within the past two weeks, two vehicles were traveling at such high speeds that they struck the curb, leaving visible tire marks. Jennifer explained that she has raised concerns about speeding on Harvest Avenue for years. While she appreciates the newly improved roadway, she believes the smoother pavement has encouraged motorists to drive even faster.

Jennifer described the measures she and her neighbors have taken to help protect their community. She stated that she has already purchased several safety signs and regularly sits in a lawn chair near the roadway so neighborhood children can safely ride their bicycles in the evenings. She also noted that another neighbor monitors traffic farther up the street. She expressed concern that, if conditions do not improve, a child, a pedestrian, or someone walking a dog could eventually be seriously injured or killed. She acknowledged that she herself could also be at risk while trying to slow traffic.

Jennifer asked Council to consider reducing the speed limit on Harvest Avenue as a practical safety measure. She stated that if the City cannot provide additional signage, she is willing to purchase it herself. However, she noted that the street does not even have a posted 25 mph speed limit sign and asked for guidance on obtaining appropriate signs, such as a lower speed limit sign and "Children at Play" signs, including the associated costs.

(8) Sue Renderle: Referenced the January 28, 2026, Ohio Department of Transportation (ODOT) presentation, during which

Carolyn Duffy, President of 143 Engineers LLC, presented crash statistics for Reading Road covering the previous five years. According to the presentation, there were 949 reported crashes during that period. Of those, 10 involved pedestrians and eight involved bicyclists, for a combined total of 18 crashes, representing approximately 1.9% of all reported crashes. The presentation also indicated that approximately 10.9% of the crashes were identified as speed-related. Additionally, the highest recorded speed associated with a speed-related crash was reported to be 33 miles per hour. Based on these figures, Sue questioned whether the available crash data supports the conclusion that Reading Road has a significant safety problem requiring a road diet.

Sue also encouraged Council to consider the potential economic effects of a road diet. She stated that many businesses along Reading Road rely on convenient access, adequate traffic flow, and visibility to attract customers. In her view, reducing roadway capacity could increase congestion, make businesses less accessible, and negatively affect local commerce. She asked Council whether members had spoken directly with business owners along Reading Road to understand their perspectives on the proposed changes.

Sue concluded by thanking the City for implementing the **TextMyGov** notification system. She said it has been an effective way to keep residents informed about important news and events happening throughout the community.

(9) Maggie Wilson: Addressed Council regarding the importance of representation and the responsibility elected officials have to their constituents.

(10) Ryan Hasty: Addressed the council regarding the proposed Reading Road diet, emphasizing the importance of representing residents' concerns, evaluating alternative safety measures, and considering the broader community impacts.

(11) Sharon Highly: Addressed the council with questions regarding access to project data, alternative safety solutions, and concerns about the proposed road diet.

(12) Liza Durbin: Addressed the council regarding concerns about traffic diversion and the potential impact on residents living along surrounding side streets.

READING OF COMMUNICATIONS:

(1) June 2026 Mayor's Court Monthly Disbursement Report

90 Bench warrants Issued, 194 Cases Heard & $18,635.00 Collected

(2) **Marie Raver Email:** *"Please, to the mayor, council members, and anyone else who votes on this. It is not beneficial to anyone to vote yes on this awful plan. Vote no. Also, why do police have to do traffic on overtime? That makes zero sense! What are they doing for the entire shift now? I see them sitting in their cars at a park for long periods of time."*

Diana Marra Email: *"I am a Reading Ohio resident for more than 30 years. I love it here - the sense of community, local businesses, our world famous Bridal District. We've got big city opportunities with a friendly small town feel.*

We are already congested at various times during the day and evening (not just at "Rush Hour") while we have 4 open lanes of traffic, plus some occasional Turning lanes. And we have railroad tracks crossing Reading Rd with an active train system. There is already added congestion every time someone wants to turn into, or leave from businesses that are directly on Reading Road itself The idea of consolidating these 4 traffic lanes down into 2 lanes is absurd - absolutely LUDICROUS! This concept will only harm our businesses and totally aggravate those passing through, as well as us, the residents of Reading.
I AM AGAINST THE READING ROAD DIET."

Don & Rose Lindeman Email: "*City Council Members, **We are opposed to the Reading Road Diet.***

Here are many reasons why traffic will be at a standstill;

We have many types of service that will slow (or stop) traffic, Amazon delivery trucks, UPS delivery trucks, water main breaks, street sweepers, utilities repair, Railroad crossings stopped, trash pick-up, recycling pickup, trash and recycling are 5 days a week. Also, ambulance and fire runs, police stops, funeral processions and traffic accidents.

Metro Buses have 15-20 bus stations in Reading. They travel through Reading 40-50 times each way, 7 days a week, they do this every 15-40 minutes. They don't always pull over far enough to get by.

What will happen when they close I-75 for changes or repairs? Traffic is rerouted to Reading Rd. That will be more of a nightmare.

Then you have all the big and small local businesses that are in Reading, morning and late afternoon traffic as they come and go to and from work.

With all this slowed down traffic caused by the road diet, it will hurt our local businesses, why go to Vonderharr's, Reading Feed Mill, Skyline, Theis Motor, just to name a few. People will avoid Reading Road businesses and go elsewhere.

We understand the main reason for the road diet is to slow down traffic, that's like punishing the entire class when one child acts up! Please just give out more tickets to the speeders. Let them know if you break the speed limit in Reading or run a red light, you WILL get a ticket!!

Thanks for your thoughtful consideration on this matter."

Steve & Peggy Koetter Email: *"My name is Steve Koetter, lifelong resident, 4th generation Readingite and I live at: 17 Orchard Knoll Drive, Reading.*

I have been watching and listening to info regarding the changes being discussed to change Reading Rd from 4 lanes to 3. My wife Peggy and I would like you to know that we strongly disagree with changing it to 3 lames, please keep it at 4 lanes and repair the Road where needed.

I work for Electrical Distributor that is located on Riverside Drive east of Montgomery Inn Boathouse and they did that to our area and it is almost impossible to get out of our parking lot at 5:00pm I don't think going from 4 lanes to 3 will help our daily lives and certainly will hurt the businesses om Reading Rd and nearby streets

Thanks for taking time to read my opinion and Thanks for your service for us."

Motion made by Mrs. Eadicicco, seconded by Mrs. Kroeger to mark all communications received and filed.
Motion carried by voice vote.

LEGISLATIVE SESSION

READING OF RESOLUTIONS:

(1) A RESOLUTION SUPPORTING OHIO DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION'S READING ROAD (US 42) ROAD DIET. (*Second Reading*)

Councilman, Mark Bishop Comments, Pre-vote:

Over the past year we've had the opportunity to look at a relatively new concept, presented by ODOT to improve traffic safety on Reading Road. Now that the final plan has been presented, It's clear to me that the proposal is not popular in the City of Reading. We don't know if it's a majority that disapprove, but support of the plan has been virtually non-existent.

The concept had potential, but after looking at other areas where this was implemented, it's clear that it's not an apples to apples comparison. Reading Rd. is very diverse. Along this stretch of roadway, we have a lot of small businesses, houses, cross streets and Railroad Tracks all in a short mile-and-a-half stretch between Galbraith Rd. and Cooper Rd.

It needs to be noted that as a US Hwy., Reading Rd. or US 42, doesn't meet the standards for the type of truck traffic that it hosts due to its 9-1/2ft lane widths which, along with speeding and pedestrian safety, this project was meant to improve.

Unpopular decisions sometimes have to be made for the greater public good. People are outraged, but the result is good. Our job is to do our homework, study the plans and data, ask the right questions and gather public input . I don't believe this project would be for the greater long-term good, nor do I think it would be an improvement right now. Unfortunately, traffic diversion onto side streets is a real concern that would be unavoidable. Reading residents know all of the side streets and they will use them. There are too many possible outcomes to accurately predict.

It is unfortunate that this is being proposed now. For several years, I-75 construction will be up-ending the lives and community of our friends and neighbors in Lockland and straining our already crowded Reading Road at times. There is too much uncertainty during construction, I'm not sure that there could have been a worse time to propose such a project. The I-75 construction, when finished should Improve traffic flow on the Interstate and likely reduce traffic on reading Road.

I appreciate all of the comments, emails and questionnaire responses that we've received. I've had some great conversations about the project. A lot of people have taken the time to study the drawings and provide thoughtful feedback. I also want to thank our representatives at ODOT for all of their hard work. I know their objective is to complete a successful project that meets or exceeds its targeted goals.

I'm in favor of utilizing some of the ideas we've gained from this process. Raised crosswalks with better lighting, better lit intersections, traffic light improvements, etc. Although it won't make the lanes any wider, I think these changes would make our streets safer without reducing the number of lanes. I also understand that the City will have to pay for some of these safety improvements.

I'd like to point out that people have frequently cited Evendale's opposition to the Road Diet as a prime example for us to follow. It should be noted that the 2 stretches of road are as different as night and day. Evendale also has absolutely NO parking anywhere on Reading Road between Reading and Sharonville. That particular fact was somehow missed by everyone on Facebook. That's why we appreciate it when people contact us directly and come to council meetings and not rely on social media for accurate information. We want to have those conversations.

As a Council Member, my optimism does not necessarily indicate support for a proposal. I feel it would have been irresponsible to rely on my first impressions before understanding the details of the final proposal. I'm obligated to give all proposals the careful consideration they deserve. Since this decision will be up to Council and not the electorate, public opinion is essential to the process. Therefore, I am not in favor of the Road Diet.

Councilman, Dave Powell Comments, Pre-vote:
Mr. Powell added to Mark's comments regarding the ODOT proposal. When ODOT presented the project, a question was raised about whether the community could select certain aspects of the plan while leaving out others, similar to a cafeteria-style approach. ODOT indicated that it was an all-or-nothing proposal.

Another question raised at the time was whether ODOT would commit to making corrective changes if certain aspects of the project did not work as intended. ODOT was not able to make that commitment.

While I agree with Mark that the plan is reasonable and has some positive elements, I do not believe the timing is right given the current circumstances. Perhaps after I-75 is reduced and widened, it would be an appropriate time to revisit the project and evaluate what the area looks like at that point.

For now, I believe we should move past the road diet project and focus on other aspects of the plan that we believe could be effective. Those improvements will likely require local funding, but we can incorporate elements that would improve pedestrian safety and continue moving forward. I believe that would be our best path ahead.

Motion made by Mrs. Eadicicco, seconded by Mr. Bronner, to suspend the rule that requires a third reading. Motion carried by a 7-0 roll call vote. Motion made by Mr. Boehner, seconded by Mr. Bronner to adopt the resolution. Motion FAILED by a 0-7 roll call vote.

RESOLUTION FAILED

Councilwoman, Katie Eadicicco Comments, Post Vote:
I wanted to take a moment to explain my vote.

This has been an ongoing and controversial topic for more than a year. Since ODOT first proposed this plan, I've been approached and contacted by many residents. Along the way, there's also been a great deal of misinformation. I've heard firsthand that some people believe this is a City project, that the City is adding roundabouts, or that intersections are being eliminated. None of those statements accurately reflect the proposal. That's why I want to again stress the importance of watching Council meetings and reaching out to the City or Council members directly with questions.

The administration has also received a lot of criticism over this proposal, and many people assumed the City supported it simply because ODOT offered to fund the entire project. To some extent, I understand why the administration took the proposal seriously. It's not every day that a state agency offers to fully fund a project intended to improve the safety and well-being of our community. I don't fault the administration or my fellow Council members for giving the proposal a thorough review.

I also want to acknowledge that I understand ODOT's intentions, and I don't believe they brought this proposal forward with ill

intentions, or that they don't care what would have happened once the road diet was completed. There are aspects of the plan that I agree with, and I don't believe it would have been as detrimental as some have suggested. That said, I've had reservations since the proposal was first introduced.

From the beginning, I've been concerned about the potential for increased traffic on side streets and heavier congestion in the areas north of Columbia and south of Jefferson. I also wanted to see additional data examining traffic patterns at different times of day, different times of the year, and a more thorough analysis of the impact on surrounding streets. Another concern was the timing of the project, especially with the upcoming Through the Valley project on I-75 and the effect that construction could have on traffic in this area. I've been open and consistent about these concerns from day one.

I understand that the goal of this road diet proposal is to improve safety for residents, motorists, and pedestrians, and I appreciate that objective. My vote should not be interpreted as opposition to ODOT's plan itself. Rather, I voted based on the overwhelming feedback I received from the community and the overwhelming opposition to the road diet. I listened to residents and folks from neighboring communities, read their comments, considered their questions and concerns, and ultimately voted no because I believe that was the position the people I represent

wanted me to take.

(2) A RESOLUTION EXPRESSING OPPOSITION TO OHIO DEPT.OF TRANSPORTATION'S READING RD (US 42) ROAD DIET

Motion made by Mr. Powell, seconded by Mrs. Kroeger, table this ordinance.
Motion carried by a 1-6 roll call vote (Mr. Boehner voting "no," and Mr. Powell, Mr. Bronner, Mr. Bishop, Mr. Thamann, Mrs, Kroeger & Mrs. Eadicicco voting "yes").

RESOLUTION TABLED

(3) A RESOLUTION ADOPTING HAMILTON COUNTY'S RECONNECTING COMMUNITIES AND NEIGHBORHOODS PLAN.

Motion made by Mr. Thamann, seconded by Mrs. Eadicicco, to suspend the rule that requires a second & third reading. Motion carried by a 7-0 roll call vote. Motion made by Mrs. Kroeger, seconded by Mr. Bronner to adopt the resolution. Motion carried by a 7-0 roll call vote.

RESOLUTION ADOPTED **RESOLUTION NUMBER 2026-22R**

READING OF ORDINANCES: NONE

MISCELLANEOUS BUSINESS:

(1) Bo Bemmes: Announced that the city has been approached by Sycamore Township regarding the creation of a joint economic development district. Sycamore Township is interested in entering into an agreement with the city. The city will work with its bond counsel, Brenda Wiemer, to assist with the necessary steps for approving the joint economic development district on property located within and owned by Sycamore Township. More information will be provided at upcoming meetings, including details about a future public hearing. The proposed area is located south on Reading Road near the former carousel area. If approved, the agreement would provide benefits to the city for services and support that have been provided in that area for many years.

The discussion surrounding the Reading Road road diet project also prompted the city to investigate the condition of the water mains beneath Reading Road. While the engineering review is not yet complete, the estimated project cost has already exceeded $4 million. Some of the existing water mains are very old, and the necessary improvements would have delayed the road project by more than a year even if it had moved forward. The city wanted residents to be aware of this additional factor affecting the project timeline.

The city recently held its pre-construction meeting for the Crestmont, East Crest, and West Crest improvements. The project will include water main replacements, paving, stormwater connections, curb work, and pavement improvements. The new water mains will be installed along Crestmont, East Crest, and West Crest from Crestmont to Keith Drive. Construction is expected to begin as soon as possible after January 5, weather permitting. There had been discussions about beginning the water main work

during the winter; however, the city decided against that approach due to past experiences with winter construction projects creating significant disruptions for residents during the holiday season. A previous project on Maple Drive resulted in construction traffic and challenges for residents throughout the Christmas and holiday period. The city anticipates the project will be completed by the end of June or July, depending on weather and construction conditions. Officials recognize that this will be another challenging project and will continue communicating updates with residents. The new water main will be installed in a separate trench from the existing water main, allowing water service to continue until individual service lines can be connected to the new system. During routine connections, water interruptions are expected to last approximately 20 to 30 minutes, and residents will receive advance notice. When larger connections are completed at Hunt Road and Keith Drive, some residents may experience longer interruptions lasting two to four hours. The city plans to schedule those major connections between approximately 9:00 a.m. and 2:00 p.m. and will provide residents with advance notification. Additional information about the project will be shared as construction progresses.

ADJOURNMENT

Motion to adjourn came from Mrs. Kroeger, and was seconded by Mr. Boehner. Motion carried by voice vote. There being no further business, the meeting was declared adjourned at 9:03 pm.

X_____ X_____

Carla Bronner
Clerk of Council

Kevin Mattscheck
President of Council